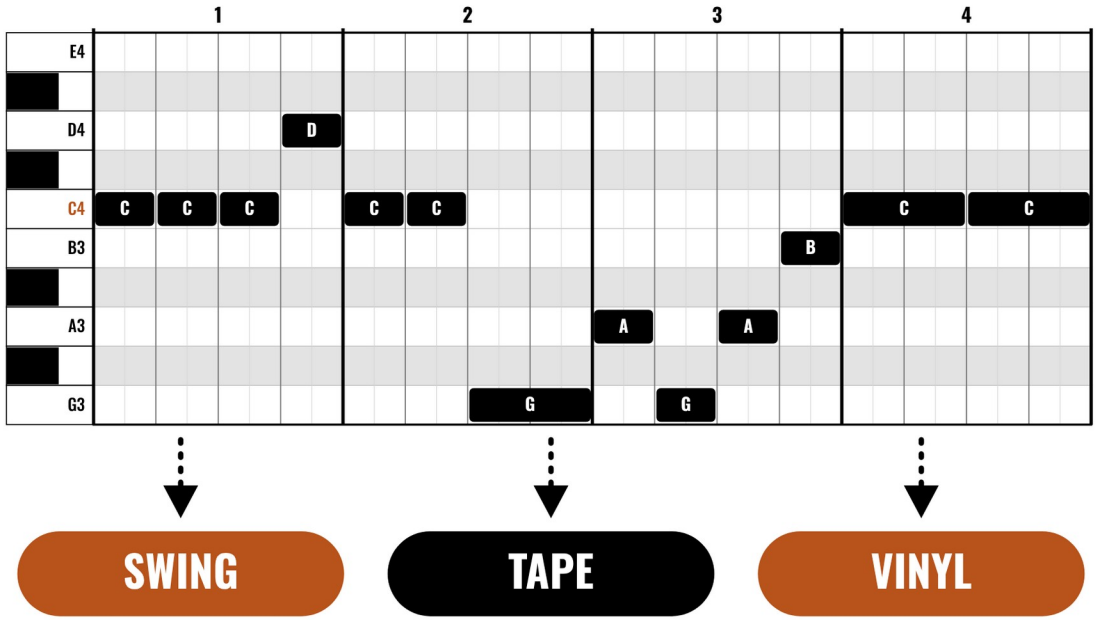
HUDSON BEAT



LO-FI HOLIDAY BEAT

A carol, slowed down and dusted off.

LOGIC PRO PROJECT · CLASS 1 · A CAROL, REWOUND

THINK: WHAT MAKES MUSIC SOUND LO-FI?

THINK, THEN SHARE

Teacher: say or hum the first line of Good King Wenceslas, first bright and crisp, then slow, soft and a little behind the beat.

- What changed?
- What would make it sound warm or old?
- Which sounds would you add?

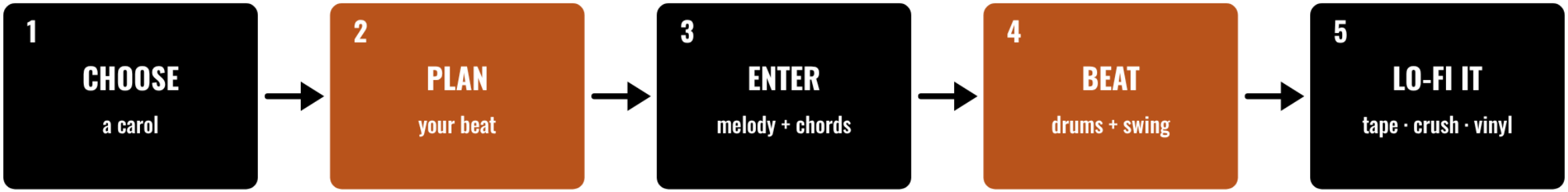
WHAT IS LO-FI HOLIDAY BEAT?

- Choose a public-domain carol
- Enter its melody and chords in Logic Pro
- Make it lo-fi: swing, tape, bitcrush, vinyl noise
- Finish a 60 to 90 second beat

FOUR CLASSES

CLASS 1	A carol, rewound · five moves · reading a piano roll
CLASS 2	Build the beat · straight or swung · three drum patterns
CLASS 3	Worked example, 84 seconds · make it lo-fi, keep the tune
CLASS 4	Checklist · rubric · presentations

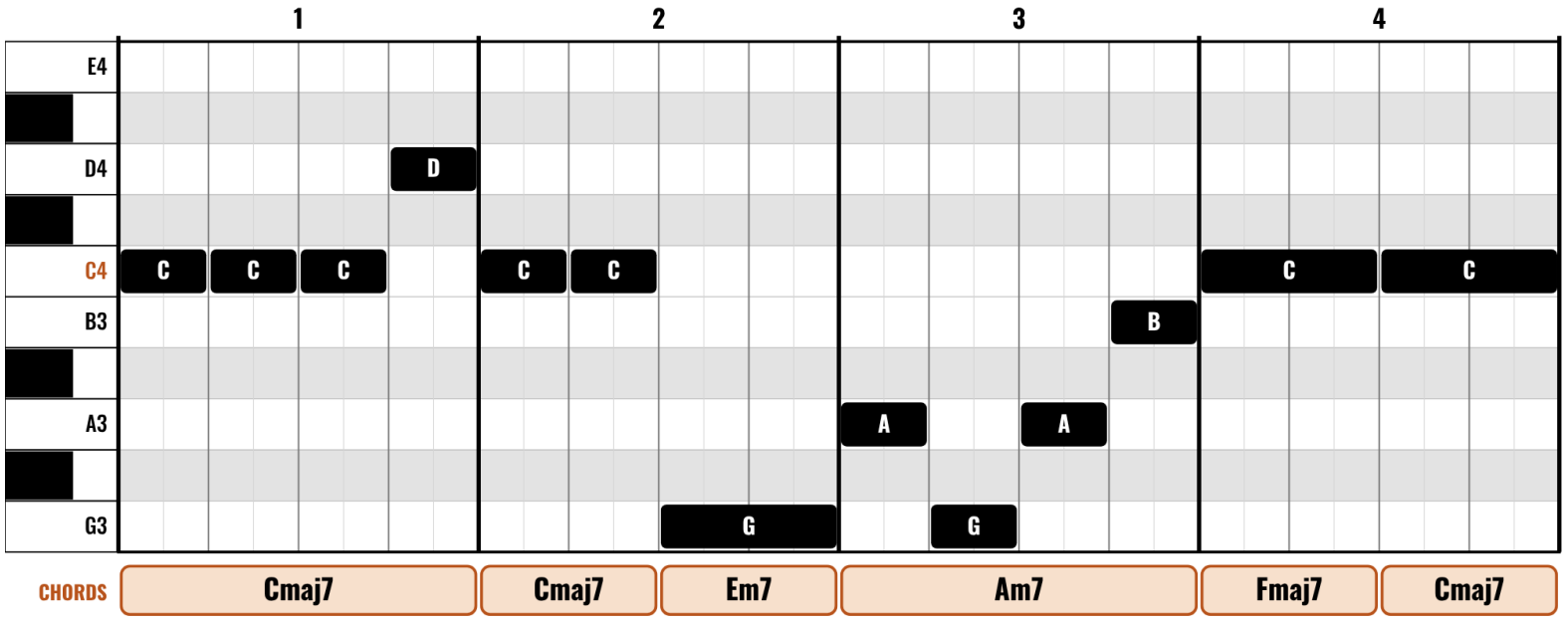
FIVE MOVES, THEN FINISH



Then arrange, mix, bounce, present and reflect

- Choose a carol and a tempo
- Enter the melody and chords
- Plan your beat and lo-fi moves
- Beat first, then lo-fi it, then arrange

READING A PIANO ROLL

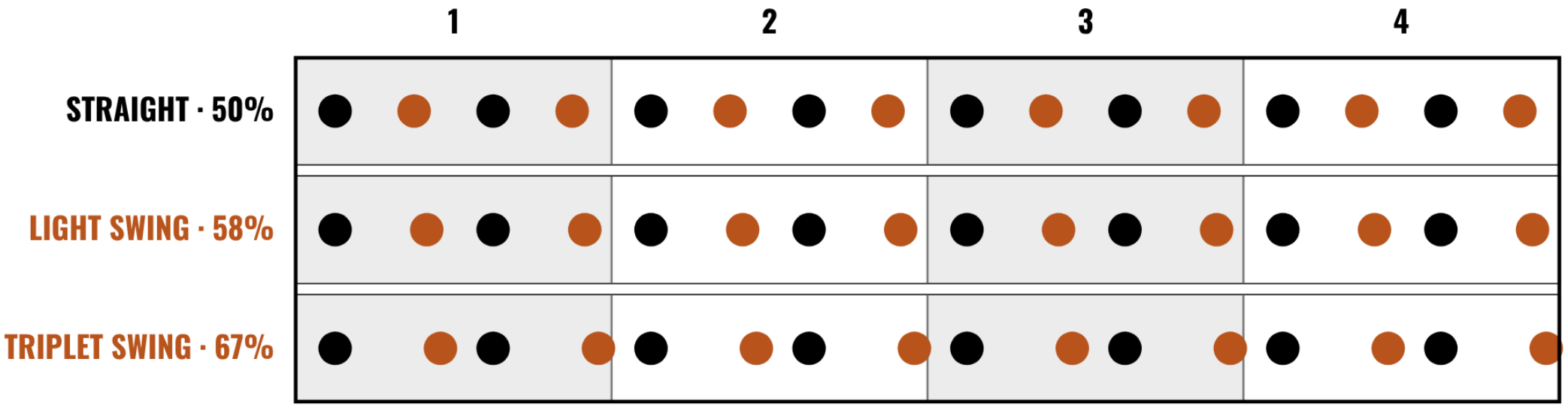


- Higher bar means higher pitch
- Longer bar means a longer note
- Left to right is time, bar by bar
- The chords are one idea that fits

BUILD THE BEAT

1. Set the tempo, 70 to 90 BPM
2. Pick a drum pattern: kick, snare, hats
3. Enter it in the Step Sequencer, or start from a Drummer track
4. Swing it: Quantize 1/16, then Q-Swing
5. Add a soft bass on the chord roots

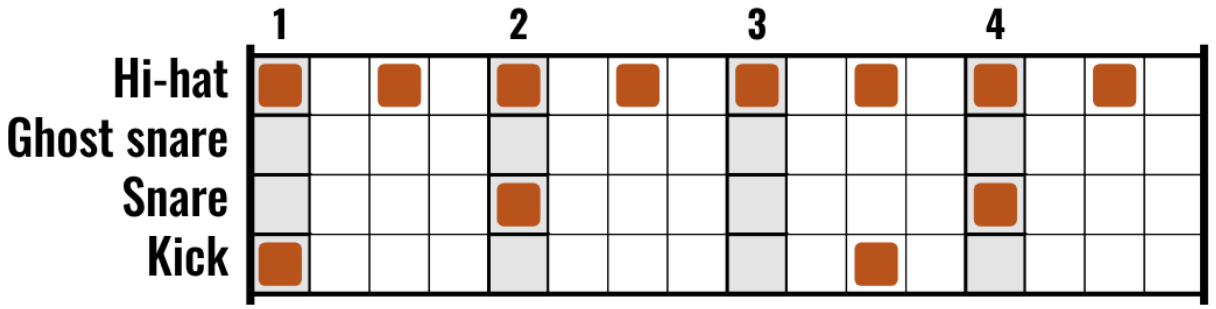
STRAIGHT OR SWUNG?



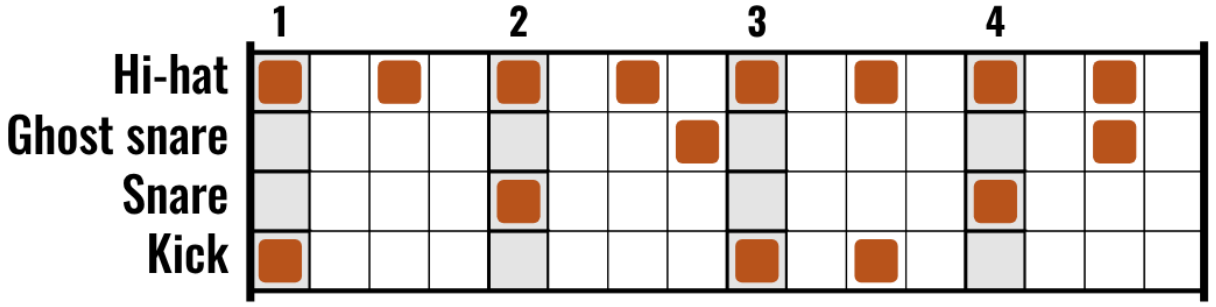
At 80 BPM a 16th note lasts 187.5 ms: light swing is 30 ms late, triplet swing 62.5 ms late

- Black dots stay on the grid
- Straight marches, swing bounces
- Orange dots land later and later
- Q-Swing in the Region inspector

THREE LO-FI DRUM PATTERNS



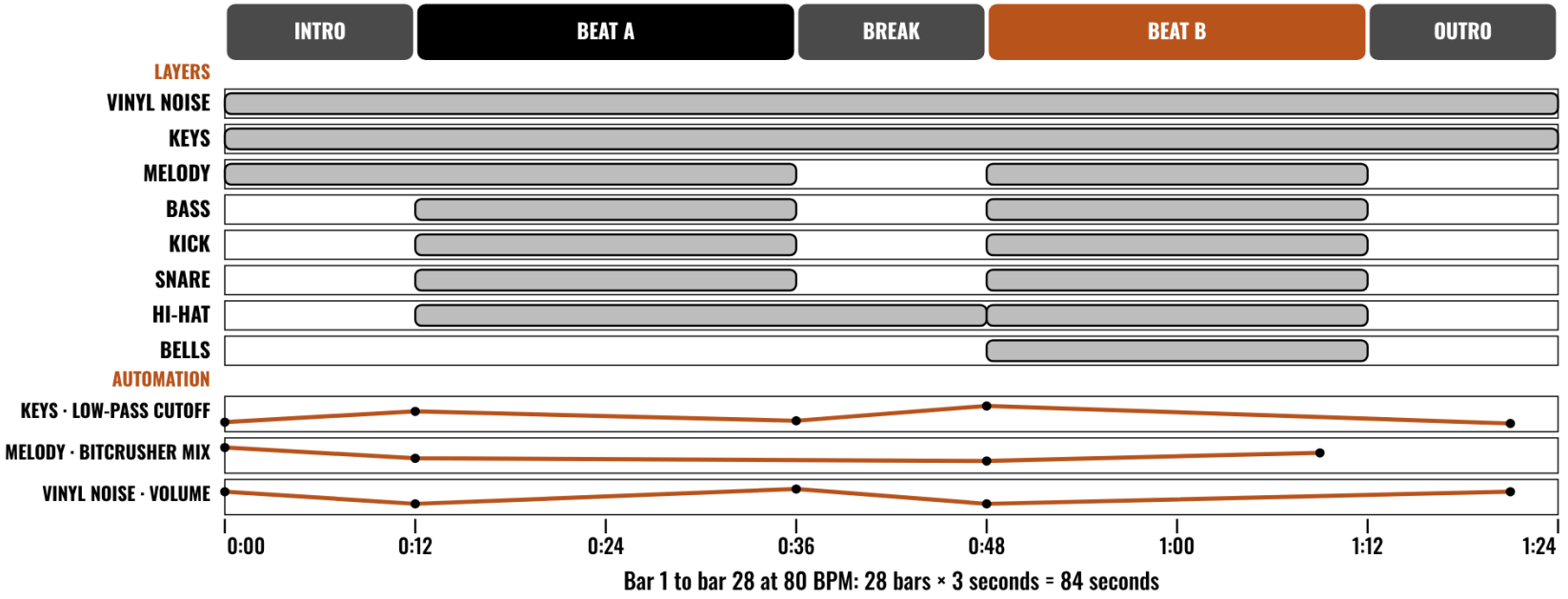
Lazy kick



Ghost notes

Same grid, two lo-fi feels: pattern A (lazy kick) and pattern C (ghost notes on top)

WORKED EXAMPLE: 84 SECONDS



- An invented 84-second beat
- Eight layers, three automation lanes
- Five sections: 4, 8, 4, 8, 4 bars
- Beat B has the most layers

MAKE IT LO-FI, KEEP THE TUNE

- Low-pass the keys: soften the highs
- Tape: a little wobble and echo
- Bitcrusher on one sound, not everything
- Vinyl noise: so quiet you miss it when it stops

WHAT YOU TURN IN

- [ ] Bounced .mp3 or .wav
- [ ] Zipped .logicx project
- [ ] Named: Your Name – Lo-Fi Holiday Beat – Carol
- [ ] Beat plan, Arrangement plan, Reflection
- [ ] Rubric self-score
- [ ] Three questions for classmates

HOW IT'S SCORED

MELODY & CHORDS	5 = Exact, with chords and a bass line that support the melody; the carol is unmistakable	/ 5
LO-FI BEAT	5 = A relaxed, bouncing groove: swing, drums and bass lock together	/ 5
LO-FI SOUND	5 = Every effect is used on purpose, with automation, and the carol is still clear	/ 5
ARRANGEMENT & MIX	5 = A form that builds and resolves; every layer audible, melody on top, noise quiet	/ 5
PLAN & REFLECTION	5 = Insightful reflection and a polished, confident presentation	/ 5

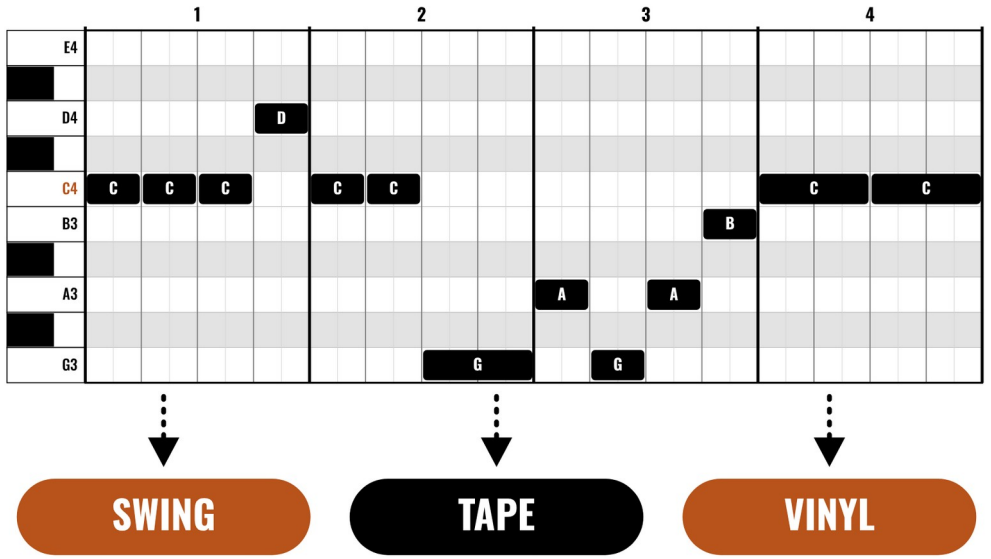
SCORED 1–5 · FINAL GRADE = AVERAGE OF YOUR SCORE AND MINE · / 25

PRESENTATION DAY

- Play your beat, then name the carol
- Say which lo-fi moves you used
- Your three questions for classmates
- Answer at least 2 of each classmate’s

ONE LAST THING...

- You picked a carol.
- You slowed it down.
- You added the dust.
- Now press play.



REFLECTION · PAGE 26

Write it or talk it through: what went well, what was hard, what you would change.